From Experience to Understanding: The Need for Phenomenological Insights into Cerebral Visual Impairment

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Intro

Cerebral Visual Impairment (CVI) Explained

- Definition: CVI is a neurological disorder that disrupts the visual processing pathways in the brain.
- Impact on Daily Life: Individuals with CVI face challenges in education, mobility, and personal interactions.
- Current Research Scenario: The bulk of CVI research today hinges on quantitative data collection and analysis.
- A Crucial Gap: Existing research methods provide numbers but fall short in capturing the intricate tapestry of individual experiences.

CVI By The Numbers

- Scope of Impact: In the US alone, CVI affects 180,449 young individuals.
- Diagnosis Concern: A mere 14% of those affected are accurately diagnosed and are privy to necessary interventions.

Enter Phenomenology

- What is Phenomenology? A research approach dedicated to understanding the lived experiences and perceptions of individuals.
- Relevance to CVI: While quantitative data tells us "what" and "how much," phenomenology dives into the "why" and "how" of CVI experiences.
- The Power of Personal Narratives: Phenomenology offers a deeper, more human-centric understanding, bringing to light the real-life challenges and triumphs of those living with CVI.
- A Call to Change: To truly grasp the complexity of CVI, we must incorporate phenomenological insights and prioritize the personal narratives of those affected.

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Method

Literature Search

- Focus: Concentrated on studies related to Cortical and Cerebral Visual Impairment (CVI) from the last five years.
- Databases Used: PsycINFO and PubMed, known for their extensive collection of psychological and medical literature, respectively.
- Search Terms: "CVI," "Cortical Visual Impairment," and "Cerebral Visual Impairment."

Inclusion & Exclusion Criteria

- Included: Studies from peer-reviewed journals written in English and centered on CVI specifically.
- Excluded: Non-English publications, non-CVI-centric studies.

Systematic Review & Categorization

- Approach: Identified studies were critically reviewed and sorted into Qualitative, Quantitative, and Phenomenological based on their research methodologies.
- Exclusion: Studies not fitting into the mentioned categories were set aside for maintaining focus and consistency.
- Purpose: This classification allowed for a detailed examination of current CVI research, pinpointing the scarcity of phenomenological insights and accentuating the call for diversified research methods in upcoming CVI studies.

Results

Year	Quantitative	Qualitative	Phenomenological
2018	7	2	0
2019	5	3	0
2020	6	2	0
2021	9	1	0
2022	8	1	0
2023	4	1	1

Table 1: Research Methodologies in CVI Studies from 2018 to 2023.

Results Continued

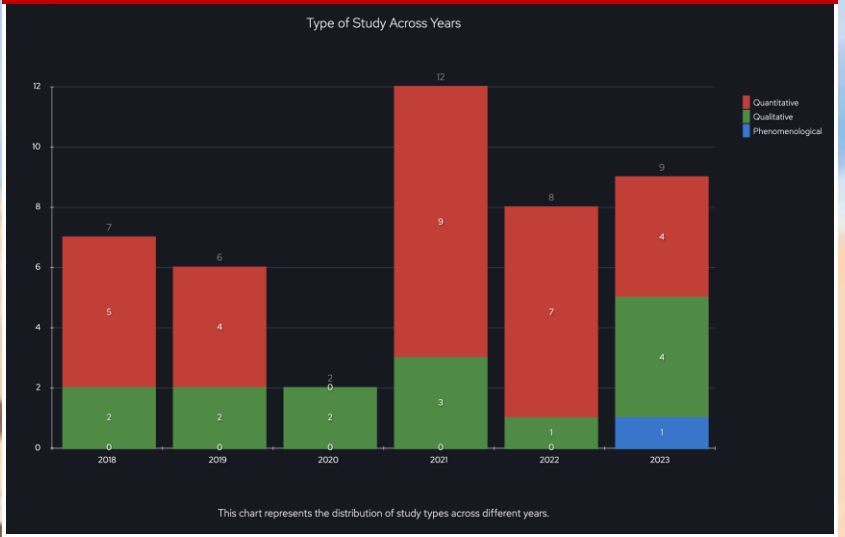


Figure 1: Research Methodologies in CVI Studies from 2018 to 2023.

Conclusion & Discussion

Gaps & Opportunities:

- Current research, while invaluable, largely focuses on physiological and clinical aspects, often sidelining the subjective experiences of CVI individuals.
- A noticeable absence of phenomenological research, which could provide richer insights into CVI experiences.

Advocating for a Paradigm Shift:

- Embracing a mix of research methodologies will lead to a holistic understanding of CVI.
- Qualitative and phenomenological studies offer context, depth, and nuanced perspectives, critical for shaping effective interventions.
- Future trajectories in CVI research and care strategies must be informed by both objective metrics and subjective narratives for a balanced, comprehensive approach.